

STAY INFORMED AND PREPARED

Why Paying Attention to Warnings is Critical

Government heat warnings are issued when conditions pose serious health risks. Health officials analyze temperature, humidity, and duration data to determine danger levels.

Heat Advisory: Conditions are dangerous and may cause heat illness, take precautions

Excessive Heat Warning: Conditions are extremely dangerous and life-threatening, avoid outdoor activities, stay inside

Stay Connected:

- Sign up for emergency alerts on your phone
- Check weather forecasts daily in summer
- Monitor the heat index, not just temperature
- Follow local health department guidance

Remember: Extreme heat is survivable with proper precautions. Stay informed, stay hydrated, stay cool, and watch out for each other



 **CALL 911 IMMEDIATELY if someone shows signs of heat stroke: confusion, loss of consciousness, hot skin, rapid pulse, slurred speech, seizures**

RECOGNIZE & RESPOND

Heat Exhaustion Treatment:

Move to a cool location immediately. Drink water, apply cool, wet clothes to skin. Loosen tight clothing. Rest in air conditioning if possible, if not seek shade.

Heat Stroke - CALL 911:

Heat stroke is a life-threatening MEDICAL EMERGENCY. Every minute counts – brain damage and organ failure can occur within ten minutes.

While Waiting for Help:

- Move person to shade or cool area immediately
- Remove excess clothing
- Cool them with whatever is available (water, ice packs, wet towels, fans)
- Focus on the neck, armpits, and groin areas
- Do NOT give fluids if unconscious
- Monitor breathing and be ready to perform CPR

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Extreme Heat: Addressing Earth's Silent Killer

WHAT IS EXTREME HEAT?

Extreme heat refers to prolonged periods of unusually high temperatures, often combined with high humidity. Heat waves typically involve temperatures significantly above the historical average for a region, lasting 2+ days.

 **Extreme heat kills more people annually than any other weather event**

WHY IS IT SO SERIOUS?

Global warming has become a critical issue with the last years experiencing extreme temperatures. Rising heat levels have led to more frequent and severe heat-related illnesses, and heat has become the #1 weather-related cause of death and injury, with about half a million fatalities occurring annually worldwide.

The human body maintains a core temperature of 98.6°F (37°C). When external temperatures rise dramatically with high humidity, the body's cooling mechanisms can fail, leading to organ damage and death within hours.

HYDRATION AND CLOTHING

Hydration is Critical

Drink water regularly throughout the day, even if you don't feel thirsty. During extreme heat, adults should drink 2-3 glasses of water every hour during outdoor activities.

Avoid alcohol, caffeine, and sugary drinks that can dehydrate you. If your urine is dark yellow, you're not drinking enough water.

Proper Clothing Matters

Wear lightweight, loose-fitting, light-colored clothing made of breathable fabrics like cotton or moisture-wicking materials. Protect your head with a wide-brimmed hat and your eyes with UV-blocking sunglasses.

Government Warnings Save Lives

Heat advisories and excessive heat warnings are issued when conditions are dangerous. These alerts are based on temperature forecasts, humidity levels, and duration. When warnings are issued, limit outdoor activities and never leave children or pets in vehicles.

Carry a water bottle everywhere and hydrate constantly

Pay attention to weather alerts and check forecasts daily

EFFECT ON THE HUMAN BODY

Heat Exhaustion

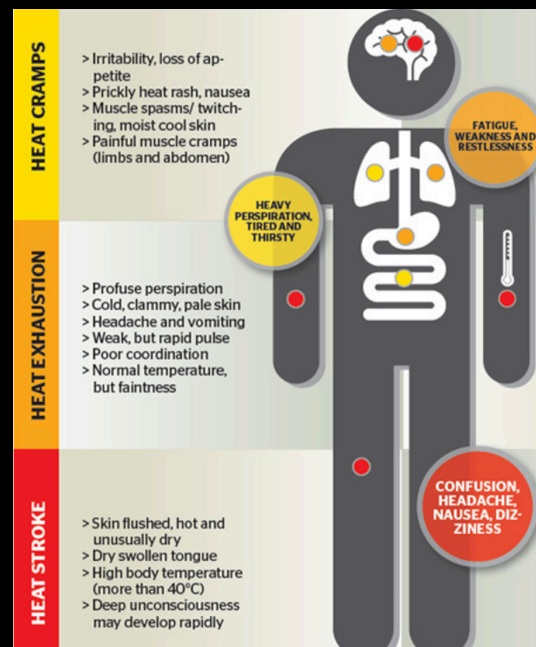
The body's first warning sign includes heavy sweating, weakness, cold/clammy skin, nausea, dizziness, and headache. This is your body telling you to cool down immediately.

Heat Stroke

A life-threatening condition where body temperature rises above 103° F. The body can no longer cool itself, and organs begin to shut down

Heat and Mental Health

Extreme heat impairs cognitive function, alters cortisol levels to trigger anxiety and aggression, increases mental health emergencies, and can lead to long-term risks of dementia.



ESSENTIAL PRECAUTIONS

During Extreme Heat:

- Stay indoors in air-conditioned spaces when possible
- If you don't have AC, go to shopping malls, libraries, or cooling centers
- Take cool showers or baths throughout the day
- Close curtains and blinds during peak sun hours
- Use fans to circulate air (only when temperatures below 95° F)
- Limit using appliances which add warmth to your environment
- Never leave anyone in a locked car
- Limit outdoor activities to cooler hours
- Take frequent breaks in the shade

For Outdoor Work or Exercise:

- Schedule activities during cooler parts of the day
- Acclimatize to high temperatures and build tolerance gradually over 1-2 weeks
- Take regular breaks every 15-20 minutes
- Work or exercise with others to help in case of heat exhaustion
- Wear sunscreen with SPF 30 or higher, reapply every 2 hours

Plan Ahead:

- Stock water and electrolyte drinks
- Identify air-conditioned locations you can access
- Know where cooling centers are located